

Adriana R. Miller

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Cognitive Psychology and Language Science

2021-present

The Pennsylvania State University, University Park, PA

ABD: Degree expected August 2027

GPA: 4.0

Advisor: Dr. Janet van Hell

M.S. in Cognitive Psychology

2023

The Pennsylvania State University, University Park, PA

GPA: 4.0

Advisor: Dr. Janet van Hell

Thesis: Novel metaphor processing in a second language: A behavioral and ERP study

B.A. in Psychology and Sociology, with Honors and Highest Distinction

2021

The University of Nebraska-Lincoln, Lincoln, NE

GPA: 4.0

Advisor: Dr. Marc Goodrich

Thesis: Effect of bilingualism on metalinguistic awareness: A meta-analysis

FELLOWSHIPS AND RESEARCH FUNDING

- **Richard F. and Barbara Knoebel Yoder Distinguished Graduate Fellowship in the College of Liberal Arts in the Field of Psychology**, *Pennsylvania State University*, 2021-2026 (\$152,500; \$30,500/year awarded competitively by the College of the Liberal Arts to a small group of top applicants)
- **Research of Graduate Studies Office (RGSO) Award**, *Pennsylvania State University*, 2025 (\$2000)
- **Center for Language Science Funding to Support Pilot Studies for Doctoral Dissertation Research & Doctoral Dissertation Grant Applications**, *Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University*, 2025 (\$1000)
- **Partnerships for International Research and Education (NSF PIRE) Fellowship**, *Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University*, 2023 (Research and international travel funds for two months, approximately \$11,400)
- **Undergraduate Creative Activities and Research Experience Grant**, *University of Nebraska-Lincoln*, 2018 (\$2400)

AWARDS AND HONORS

- **Best Paper Award**, *Psychology Department, Pennsylvania State University*, 2026
- **Superior Research and Teaching (STAR) Award**, *College of the Liberal Arts, Pennsylvania State University*, 2026 (\$1950 to fund wages for a summer undergraduate research assistant)
- **Adele Miccio Memorial Networking Travel Award**, *Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University*, 2026 (\$1400 to travel to the University of York, UK to network and present my dissertation research)
- **Fulbright English Teaching Assistant Grant**, 2021 (Awarded, Declined)
- **Chancellor's Scholar Award**, *University of Nebraska-Lincoln*, 2021

- **Regents Scholarship**, *University of Nebraska-Lincoln*, 2017-2021 (Full tuition and stipend, approximately \$27,000)
- **Susan Thompson Buffet Foundation Scholarship**, 2017-2021 (Full tuition, approximately \$24,000)

PUBLICATIONS

- Zaharchuk, H. A., Walker, A., **Miller, A. R.**, Fernandez, C., van Hell, J. G. (2026). Expecting a challenge: A behavioral and neurophysiological investigation in cross-dialectal speech perception. *Laboratory Phonology*, 17(1). doi: 10.16995/labphon.19053
- **Miller, A. R.**, Dickson, D. S., Jończyk, R., Lei, D., Kremer, G., E., Siddique, Z., Beaty, R. E., & van Hell, J. G. (2025). Critical feedback impacts creative ideation and EEG oscillations. *Neuropsychologia*, 220, 109307. doi: 10.1016/j.neuropsychologia.2025.109307
- **Miller, A. R.**, Jończyk, R., Zaharchuk, H. A., & van Hell, J. G. (2025). Unlocking second language novel metaphor processing: Behavioral and ERP insights from first and second-language English users. *Psychophysiology*, 62(5). doi: 10.1111/psyp.70066

SUBMITTED MANUSCRIPTS

- **Miller, A. R.**, Dickson, D. S., Pifer, E., Beaty, R. E., Hopp, H., van Hell, J. G. (Under review). Creativity in two languages: Convergent and divergent thinking performance in German-English bilinguals.
- **Miller, A. R.**, Giorio, C., Stokes, G., Brouwer, S., & van Hell, J. G. (Under review). Recognizing emotions in a second language: Examining Dutch-English bilinguals' recognition of basic emotions in Dutch, English, Arabic, and Hindi.

PRESENTATIONS

* denotes undergraduate student mentees

Invited Oral Presentations

- **Miller, A. R.**, Baker Z., DiStefano, P. V., Drais-Parillo, A. (September 17, 2026). *What helps students remember? Grades, interest, and study time as predictors of content retention over time*. Talk at Virtual Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Summit.
- **Miller, A. R.** and van Hell, J. G (May 22, 2026). *Neural processes underlying novel word consolidation in L1 and L2: The role of prior semantic knowledge*. Virtual talk for members of University of Arizona Child Cognition Lab.
- **Miller, A. R.** and van Hell, J. G. (March 10, 2026). *Novel word learning in L1 and L2: The role of prior semantic knowledge*. Talk for Sleep, Language, and Memory Lab Group at the University of York, York, UK.
- Walker, A., *Hampton, C., Wood, W., Zaharchuk, H. A., **Miller, A. R.**, & van Hell, J. G. (April 2024). *Bidialectal brains: Profiles of event related potentials in a cross-dialectal listening task in Southern US English speakers*. Talk at Southeastern Conference on Linguistics, Athens, GA.

Poster Presentations

- **Miller, A. R.**, & van Hell, J. G. (March 2026). *Examining the role of prior semantic knowledge in neural processing of novel words*. Poster at 41st Annual Graduate Exhibition, State College, PA.
- **Miller, A. R.**, Dickson, D. S., Jończyk, R., Lei, D., Kremer, G., E., Siddique, Z., Beaty, R. E., & van Hell, J. G. (May 2025). *Critical feedback impacts creative ideation and EEG alpha activity in engineering students*. Poster at the Society for the Neurobiology of Creativity, Paris, France.
- *Pineda Velasquez, M. E., *Jaen Pabon, A. C., **Miller, A. R.**, Brouwer, S. M., van Hell, J. G. (February 2025). *Recognition of emotion in second language speech in quiet and noise conditions*. Poster at the Young Language Science Scholars Poster Session, State College, PA.

- **Miller, A. R.,** *Stokes, G., Brouwer, S., van Hell, J. G. (November 2024). *Recognizing emotion in second-language speech: A study of bilinguals' emotional prosody recognition in quiet and noisy conditions*. Poster at Psychonomic Society, New York City, NY.
- *Stokes, G., **Miller, A. R.,** Diaz, M, Brouwer, S., & van Hell., J. G. (September 2024). *Understanding emotion in different languages: Emotional prosody recognition in bilinguals and the impact of background noise*. Poster presentation at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing, Edinburgh, Scotland, UK.
- *Stokes, G., **Miller, A. R.,** Diaz, M, Brouwer, S., & van Hell., J. G. (May 2024). *Understanding emotion in different languages: Emotional prosody recognition in bilinguals and the impact of background noise*. Poster presentation at Human Sentence Processing, Ann Arbor, Michigan.
- *Stokes, G., **Miller, A. R.,** Diaz, M, Brouwer, S., & van Hell., J. G. (March 2024). *Understanding emotion in different languages: Emotional prosody recognition in bilinguals and the impact of background noise*. Poster presentation at Georgetown University Round Table, Washington D. C.
- *Stokes, G., **Miller, A. R.,** Diaz, M, Brouwer, S., & van Hell., J. G. (February 2024). *Understanding emotion in different languages: Emotional prosody recognition in bilinguals and the impact of background noise*. Poster presentation at Young Language Science Scholars Event, State College, PA.
- Walker, A., Zaharchuk, H. A., **Miller, A. R.,** & van Hell, J. G. (December 2023). *Your brain on accents: Profiles of event-related potentials in cross-dialectal listening in the US English context*. Poster presentation at Acoustics, Sydney, Australia.
- **Miller, A. R.,** Jończyk, R., & van Hell, J. G. (November 2023). *Novel metaphor processing of first and second language English Speakers: A behavioral and ERP study*. Poster presentation at the Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, San Francisco, CA.
- **Miller, A. R.** & van Hell, J. G. (May 2023). *Novel metaphor processing in a second language: A behavioral and ERP study*. Poster presentation at Psycholinguistics in Flanders Conference, Ghent, Belgium.
- **Miller, A. R.** & van Hell, J. G. (October 2022). *Novel metaphor processing in a second language*. Poster presentation at the Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Philadelphia, PA.
- *Hyler, D., **Miller, A. R.,** & Goodrich, J. M. (April 2021). *Are bilinguals at an advantage in metalinguistic awareness? A meta-analysis*. Poster presentation at the University of Nebraska-Lincoln Student Research Days 2021, Lincoln, NE.
- **Miller, A.** & Goodrich, J. M. (April 2019). *Executive function and literacy skills of dual language preschoolers*. Poster presentation at the Undergraduate Research Symposium at the University of Nebraska-Lincoln, Lincoln, NE.

Departmental Seminar Presentations

- **Miller, A. R.** (October 23, 2024). *Listening out for variation: Data from a cross-dialectal listening task with Southern and Mainstream US English Listeners*. Brown Bag talk for Cognitive Psychology Department, Pennsylvania State University, University Park, PA.
- **Miller, A. R.** & van Hell, J. G. (April, 2022). *Novel metaphor processing in a second language*. Brown Bag talk for Cognitive Psychology Department, Pennsylvania State University, University Park, PA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

- PSYCH 100, Introduction to Psychology, *Pennsylvania State University*, Fall 2026
- PSYCH 426/LING 429, Language and Thought, *Pennsylvania State University*, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

- PSYCH 301W, Research Methods in Psychology, *Pennsylvania State University*, Spring 2026
- PSYCH 301W, Research Methods in Psychology, *Pennsylvania State University*, Spring 2025
- BBH 213 Neural Bases of Human Behavior, *Pennsylvania State University*, Fall 2022

- LING 426/ LING 429 Language and Thought, *Pennsylvania State University*, Fall 2022
- PSYC 181 Introduction to Psychology, *University of Nebraska-Lincoln*, Fall 2020

MENTORSHIP

- Benny Dong, Undergraduate Research Assistant, 2025-2026
- Grace Schultz, Undergraduate Research Assistant, 2025-2026
- Mavel Pineda, Undergraduate PIRE Fellowship, 2023-2025
- Solimar Rosales-Osta, Undergraduate PIRE Fellowship, 2023-2025
- Gabrielle Stokes, Undergraduate Honors Thesis & PIRE Fellowship, 2022-2024
- Ana Cecilia Jaen Pabon, Undergraduate PIRE Fellowship Research, 2023-2024

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATES

Teaching and Learning

- Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL) Associate, Practitioner, and Scholar Level Certificates (Certificates earned in Spring 2026)
- Teaching Psychology Seminar, *Psychology Department, Pennsylvania State University* (Course completed Spring 2025)
- Ethical Pedagogy Short-Course, *Schreyer Institute for Teaching Excellence, Pennsylvania State University* (Course completed Fall 2024)

Research and Methodology

- Multilevel Modelling Online Short-Course, *The Center for Integrated Latent Variable Research, University of Maryland* (Course completed Spring 2022)
- Data Analysis Internship, *Juvenile Justice Institute, Lincoln, NE* (2019-2020)

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Ad-Hoc Reviewer

Brain and Language (Co-reviewer)
 Cognitive Processing
 Journal of Neurolinguistics
 Language, Cognition, and Neuroscience
 Language Learning,
 NeuroImage (Co-reviewer)

Pennsylvania State University

- Graduate Liaison to the Psychology Department Director of Graduate Studies, *Department of Psychology* (Fall 2023-Spring 2025)
- Graduate Peer Mentor, *Department of Psychology* (Fall 2022-present)

University of Nebraska-Lincoln

- Cultural Ambassadors, Member (2017-2021), Treasurer (2019-2020), President (2020-2021)
- New Student Enrollment International Welcome Team, Team Lead (2018-2021)
- Honors Peer Mentor (2018-2019)

SCIENCE OUTREACH

- **Young Women in Science STEM Workshop Volunteer**, *Graduate Women in Science, Pennsylvania State University* (2026)
- **Language and Linguistics Day Volunteer**, *Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University* (2023)

- **Pennsylvania Festival for the Arts Children's Booth Volunteer**, *Center for Language Science, Pennsylvania State University* (2024, 2026)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Society for the Neuroscience of Creativity (Student Member)
- Society for the Neurobiology of Language (Student Member)
- Psychonomic Society (Student Member)
- Women in Cognitive Science (Student Member)